LinkMint

Pay anyone, anywhere, through any rail — with a link.

Non-custodial · multi-rail · blockchain-settled payments for East Africa.

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Phase 2 · Innovator Showcase · Rupa Mall, Eldoret

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THE PROBLEM

Accepting digital payments in Africa is custodial, single-rail, and hostile to small payments.

Custodial by default

Holding customer funds means a PSP / e-money licence, locked-up capital, and Central Bank approval before you can take a single shilling.

Single-rail, every time

M-Pesa *or* a card *or* a bank transfer — never one link a customer can simply open and pay, on whatever rail they already use.

Micropayment-hostile

Fixed processing fees make a tip, a song, or a single article simply not worth collecting — so a whole economy never gets built.

1–3%

Card interchange & processing fees — the wrong cost model for a KES 20 payment, before you even add a fixed per-transaction floor.

THE SOLUTION

A PayLink. Scan or click to pay — money goes straight to the receiver.

LinkMint never touches the funds. We verify a cryptographic **proof of payment** and finalise settlement on our own blockchain — the IVM.

① The PayLink

A shareable payment authorisation — a URL, a QR code, or an NFT. No payer account. No app to download.

② Non-custodial protocol

Funds flow rail → receiver directly. Because we never hold money, we sidestep PSP / e-money licensing entirely.

③ Programmable logic

One-time or multi-use, expiry, escrow conditions, and split payments — all enforced on-chain.

The money never touches LinkMint — we only move proofs, not funds.

HOW IT WORKS

Create → Pay → Settle

1 · CREATE

Mint a PayLink

Merchant creates a PayLink (URL / QR / NFT). It is minted on the IVM chain.

status: CREATED

→

2 · PAY

Payer pays

An M-Pesa STK push lands on the payer's phone. They confirm with their PIN.

M-PESA · STK push

→

3 · PROVE

Adapter signs a proof

The rail callback is normalised into a signed, rail-agnostic proof of payment.

proof signed

→

4 · SETTLE

IVM verifies

A validator checks the proof and finalises the PayLink on-chain.

status: VERIFIED ✓

```
proof_hash = SHA256( pl_id · receipt · amount )  →  verified once, replay rejected
```

LinkMint verifies cryptographic proofs — it never holds the money.

LIVE DEMO · RUNNING TODAY

Create → Pay → Settle, in about ten seconds — on our own chain.

1 Create a PayLink

Set receiver, amount and expiry. It's minted on the IVM chain — funds never touch the app.

2 Pay via M-PESA

An STK push to Pay Bill 174379. The payer confirms in their own M-Pesa app — no account, no install.

3 Settled on-chain

The signed proof is verified by a validator and the PayLink turns VERIFIED — in seconds.

```
$ make -C adapters/mpesa e2e
CREATED → VERIFIED · proof used ✓ · PASS (2.4s)
```

ACTUAL SCREEN · CAPTURED LIVE

localhost:3000 — LinkMint

Settlement • VERIFIED

Watching the PayLink settle on-chain (polling).

PayLink	0x2e62dc96fec132b92bd8df58bada88d69398 64d5a9033a06251da48eb4bea9d4
Votes	1
Chain tx	0x741c14387952d03bfacf47e4405ec082637 5ad9fddc6a782b1c0599b61b85ae8
Verified at	2026-06-02T22:03:45.832534Z

Settled on-chain.

A real PayLink 0x2e62…a9d4, **VERIFIED on-chain** with a verifiable tx hash 0x741c…b85ae8 — not a mock-up.

TRACTION · THIS IS NOT A PROTOTYPE

The whole system runs end-to-end, today.

12
production-shaped microservices

1
custom blockchain — the IVM (Go · NIST P-256)

PASS
end-to-end M-Pesa settlement test, green in CI

80%
enforced test-coverage gate

SHIPPED & RUNNING

paylink-service · payment-orchestrator · proof-validator · identity · merchant-onboarding · compliance-risk · admin-backoffice · audit-log · notifications · invoicing · Kong gateway · IVM chain · M-Pesa adapter · JS SDK · Next.js web app

PRODUCTION-GRADE BY CONSTRUCTION

Idempotency keys · Event sourcing (Kafka/Redpanda) · Tamper-evident audit hash-chain · Append-only double-entry ledger · MFA · AES-GCM encryption at rest · OpenTelemetry tracing · Architecture Decision Records

ARCHITECTURE

Layered, rail-agnostic, blockchain-settled.

CLIENTS

Next.js web app · @linkmint/sdk (TypeScript) · QR · link · NFT

EDGE

API Gateway · Kong · JWT & API-key auth · rate-limit · signed X-Creator-Addr

CORE SERVICES

paylink · payment-orchestrator · proof-validator · identity · merchant-onboarding · compliance-risk · admin · audit-log · notifications · invoicing

RAIL ADAPTERS

M-Pesa · live · Card · next · Bank · next · Crypto (USDC) · next

SETTLEMENT LAYER

IVM blockchain · Go · NIST P-256 ECDSA · single-validator devnet · BFT / multi-validator ready

SHARED BACKBONE

- Event bus
- Double-entry ledger
- Idempotency store
- Telemetry (OTel)

Identical Go + Python client libraries — every service speaks the same wire.

MARKET

Start where mobile money already won — then expand the rails.

Kenya M-Pesa → East Africa → + Card + Crypto → Global

$800B+ / yr

moves through mobile money across Sub-Saharan Africa — the rails our protocol plugs straight into. (GSMA, State of the Industry)

WHO PAYS & GETS PAID

- SMB merchants
- Payers — guest, no account
- Developers / ISVs
- Platforms & marketplaces

WHERE ONE LINK UNLOCKS NEW REVENUE

- Micropayments & tips
- Content unlocks
- Invoices & subscriptions
- Escrow & marketplaces

BUSINESS MODEL

A take-rate built for volume — and viable for the smallest payment.

0.5% ~~1–3%~~

our fee per settlement · min KES 1

card interchange

How the protocol fee is split

70% · Validators	20% · Treasury	10% · Burn

Fees reward the validators who secure the network and fund a deflationary burn. The PLN utility token aligns network security with real usage — no token speculation required to use LinkMint.

KES 1,000 sale → KES 5 fee
A normal merchant payment.

KES 50 tip → KES 1 fee
Micropayments finally make sense.

WHY LINKMINT WINS

One link does what no incumbent does at once.

	LinkMint	Traditional PSP	Card processor	Crypto wallet
Non-custodial — no PSP licence	✓	✗	✗	✓
Multi-rail in a single link	✓	partial	✗	✗
Micropayments viable	✓	✗	✗	gas-limited
No payer account / app needed	✓	✗	partial	✗
Programmable (escrow, splits, expiry)	✓	✗	✗	✓
Compliance built in (KYC / AML)	✓	✓	✓	✗
Fee on a KES 1,000 payment	0.5%	2–3%	1–3%	+ network gas

More revenue for merchants, real returns for investors, lift for the economy.

Merchants earn more

- **2–6× cheaper** than cards — 0.5% vs 1–3% keeps more of every shilling.
- **One link, every rail** → fewer abandoned checkouts, more completed sales.
- **New revenue lines**: tips, content unlocks, pay-per-use — viable only at micro-fees.

Easier to do business

- **Go live with a link** — no PSP licence, no capital lock-up, no bank integration.
- **Guest checkout**: customers pay with no account or app → higher conversion.
- **Escrow & splits** automate payouts for marketplaces and gig platforms.

A market ripe to disrupt → investor ROI

- Displaces the **custodial PSP + card-interchange** stack with a low-fee protocol.
- Take-rate on the **$800B+/yr** SSA mobile-money flow → compounding, volume-based revenue.
- **Capital-light** — no float, no licence capital — so margins and scale follow usage.

Scaling & social impact

- Brings **SMEs & informal traders** formal, low-cost digital payments — financial inclusion.
- **Auditable history** unlocks credit access; lower fees keep money in local economies.
- **Borderless rails** (USDC next) → cross-border trade & diaspora remittances.

VERTICAL EXPANSION

Where LinkMint goes next: one protocol, many verticals.

The same PayLink primitive — a link, a micro-fee, programmable and non-custodial — unlocks vertical after vertical across East Africa.

Community & group money

LIVE · M-PESA

- Chamas
- SACCOs
- Harambee
- Churches & NGOs

Micro & metered commerce

LIVE · M-PESA

- Creator tips
- PAYGo solar & water
- Transport fares
- Ticketing (NFT)

Recurring & institutional

LIVE · M-PESA

- School fees
- Subscriptions
- Micro-insurance
- Gov / e-citizen fees

Trust-based trade

PHASE 2 · ESCROW

- Social-commerce escrow
- Marketplaces
- Agri co-ops
- B2B supply

Instant payouts & gig

PHASE 2 · PAYOUTS

- Boda & delivery riders
- Freelancers
- Refunds
- Claims & stipends

Cross-border & platform

PHASE 3 · DEV-LED

- Diaspora remittances
- Embedded "PaaS" via SDK
- Alt. credit scoring

COMPLIANCE & TRUST

Non-custodial by design — compliant by construction.

Sidesteps PSP / e-money licensing

Because LinkMint never holds funds, it falls outside the Central Bank's custodial-licence regime.

KYC tiers & deterministic risk engine

Tiers 0 / 1 / 2 with a Tier-1 ceiling of KES 50,000. Every check returns allow / review / block — same inputs, same decision, every time.

Audit & integrity

Tamper-evident audit hash-chain · append-only double-entry ledger · AES-GCM at rest · multi-factor auth.

KENYA AML THRESHOLD

KES 150K

Cumulative-value transactions above the threshold are automatically held for enhanced review — built into the protocol, not bolted on.

Phase 1 is done. Now we scale rails and consensus.

Developer-led adoption (SDK + docs), SMB pilots in Eldoret & Nairobi, and a micropayment wedge — tips and content unlocks — that incumbents can't serve.

PHASE 1 · Q2 2026 — ✓ DONE

Working MVP

- IVM devnet + proof settlement
- M-Pesa rail, live
- 12 core services + JS SDK
- Web app + passing e2e

PHASE 2 · Q3 2026 — NEXT

Scale & payouts

- Card + crypto (USDC) rails
- Multi-validator BFT consensus
- Merchant payouts (settlement)
- On-chain escrow

PHASE 3 · Q4 2026 + — SCALE

Mainnet & ecosystem

- Mainnet launch
- Full multi-language SDK suite
- Production KYC vendor
- Merchant & developer dashboards

TEAM

Founder-led — hiring to scale.

VK

Victor Mbugua Kamande

FOUNDER & CEO · PROTOCOL ENGINEER

Designed and built the entire LinkMint stack end-to-end — the IVM blockchain, twelve backend services, the JavaScript SDK, and the web app — with a passing end-to-end M-Pesa settlement test in CI. [Add 1–2 lines on your background, prior work, and why you're the right person to build payments for East Africa.]

OPEN ROLES WE'RE HIRING WITH THIS ROUND

ENGINEERING
Protocol Engineer (Go · IVM)

ENGINEERING
Backend Engineer (services)

RISK
Compliance & Risk Lead

COMMERCIAL
Growth & Partnerships

Advisory — actively seeking mentors from the Rupa Mall innovator network across payments, fintech regulation, and go-to-market.

THE ASK

Let's bring programmable payments to East Africa.

WHAT WE'RE SEEKING AT THE SHOWCASE

Seed / grant capital

Funding to build Phase 2 and extend runway.

Pilot partners

Merchants & corporates to run live M-Pesa pilots.

Mentorship & advisory

Technical and regulatory guidance to scale safely.

Commercialisation

Prize & partner support to reach market.

Use of funds: multi-rail + multi-validator BFT · first merchant pilots · compliance & legal.

Get in touch

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